# Artisania

## Digitizing the Soul of Pakistani Handicrafts


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# **Problem Statement – (**Challenges in the Handicrafts Industry**)**

**Fragmented artisan communities:**

- Pakistani artisans, particularly in rural and semi-urban regions, work independently or in small family units, lacking organizational structures or cooperative networks

**Lack of access to global buyers:**

- Most artisans are disconnected from global e-commerce platforms due to language barriers, digital illiteracy, and logistical challenges.

**Exploitation by middlemen:**

- Middlemen often control access to retail markets and take a large share of artisan profits

**No digital presence or trust signals:**

- Most artisans lack websites, digital portfolios, or traceable product origins, making it difficult for global buyers to verify product authenticity or quality

Pakistani craftspeople are rich in heritage but poor in market access.”

# Why This Problem Matters

Handicrafts are not just products.
They are:

- Cultural heritage
- Livelihoods (often women-led 60-70%)
- Community identity

Yet they are disappearing.

- Global handicrafts market was approximately USD 900 billion in 2024, with forecasts toward ~USD 1.9 trillion by 2033 (CAGR ~8–9%) - IMARC

# Why Existing Platforms Fail

**Current marketplaces (Etsy, Amazon Handmade):**

- Open & self-managed
- Focus on scale, not authenticity
- Trust based only on ratings

**They are NOT designed for:**

- Cultural preservation
- Low digital literacy artisans
- Proven authenticity

# Research Gap

No integrated solution combining:

- Governance
- Authenticity verification
- Artisan support

# Our Answer: Artisania

**Artisania is a managed digital marketplace**

- Curated artisans & products
- Built-in authenticity
- Assisted digital participation

**Not just e-commerce — a socio-technical system**

# Value Proposition

## For Artisans

Access to global buyers

Protection against imitation

No need for digital expertise

## For Buyers

Verified authenticity

Cultural transparency

Ethical consumption

## Social & Ethical Added Value

### Beyond business impact:

- Women empowerment (home-based artisans)
- Cultural heritage preservation
- Ethical & responsible consumption
- Knowledge transmission across generations

# ESG & Sustainability Angle

## Environmental

- Handmade, low-industrial impact

## Social

- Fair income
- Artisan dignity
- Gender inclusion

## Governance

- Transparent verification
- Platform accountability

# How Value Is Created

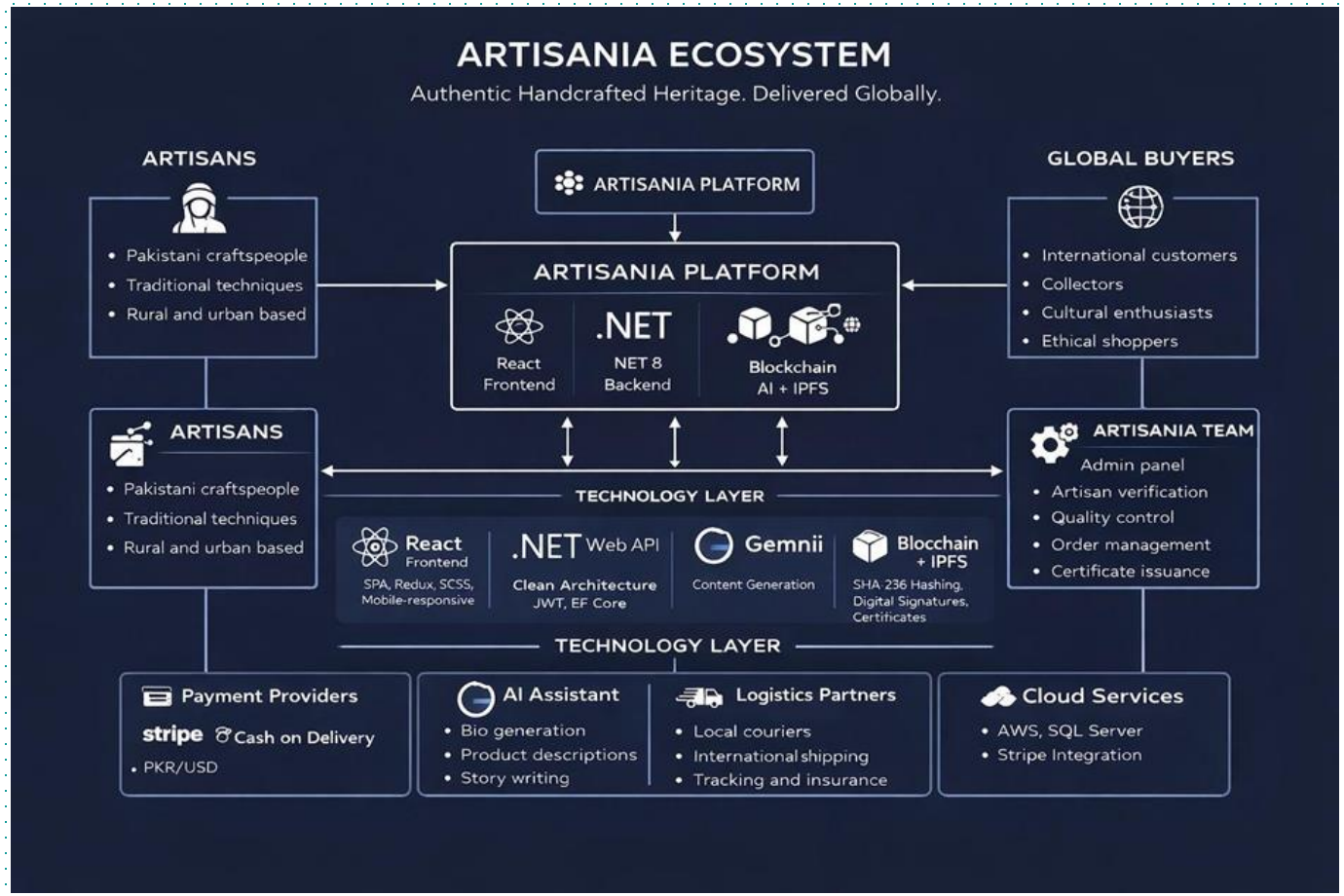
**Artisania creates value through trust**

- Verified origin
- Storytelling
- Cultural meaning

Enables premium positioning

Reduces race-to-the-bottom pricing

# Ecosystem View



# Why Managed Marketplace Matters

| **Open** | **Artisania** |
| --- | --- |
| Seller self-managed | Platform-assisted |
| Scale-first | Trust-first |
| Reactive trust | Built-in trust |

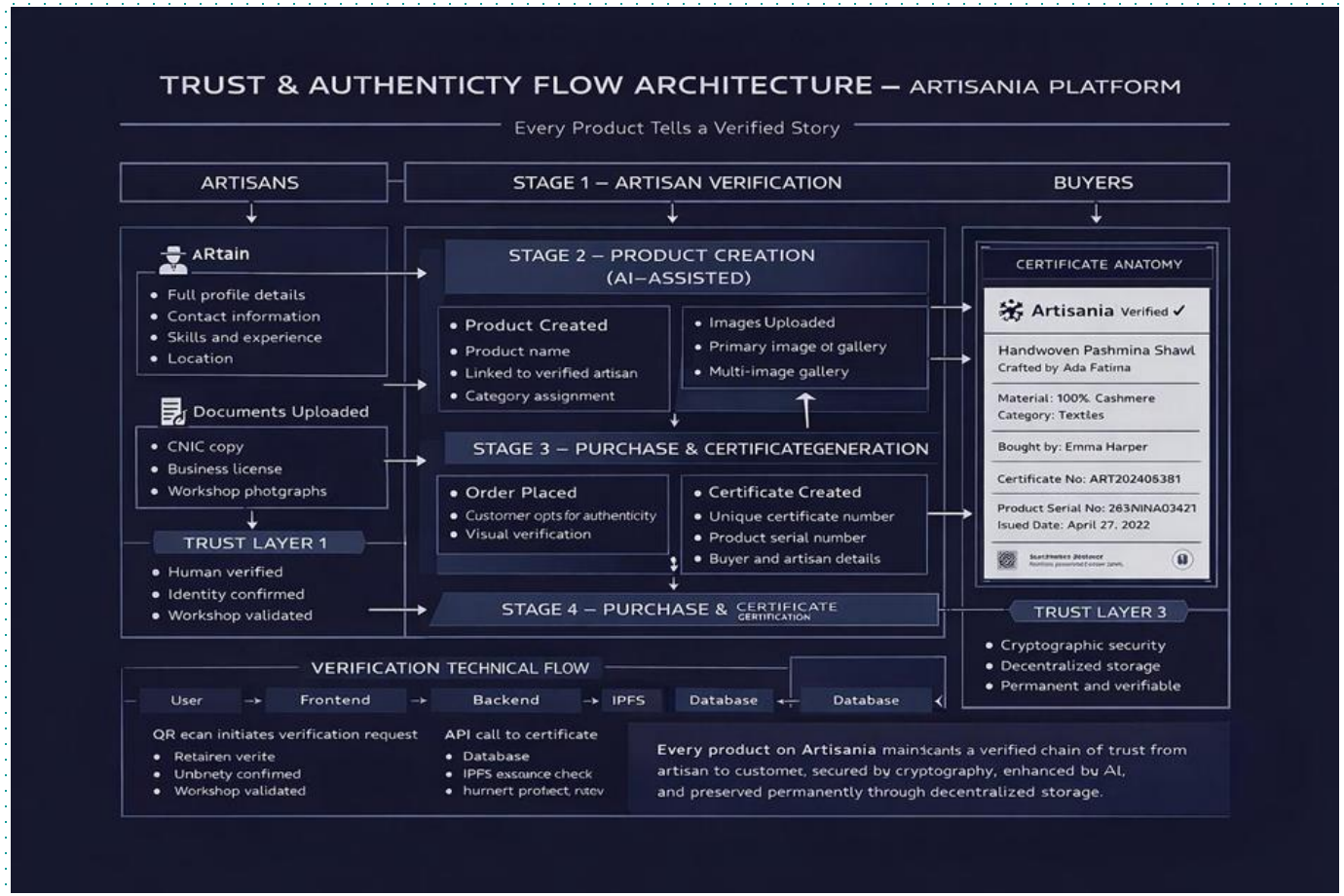
# Technology

**Technology as an enabler, not the focus**

- Blockchain → backend authenticity record
- AI → assistive storytelling & translation
- Platform → abstracts complexity

**No artisan interacts with blockchain**

# Trust Flow


TRUST & AUTHENTICTY FLOW ARCHITECTURE – ARTISANIA PLATFORM
Every Product Tells a Verified Story
ARTISANS
STAGE 1 – ARTISAN VERIFICATION
BUYERS
ARtain
Full profile details
Contact information
Skills and experience
Location
Documents Uploaded
CNIC copy
Business license
Workshop photgraphs
TRUST LAYER 1
Human verified
Identity confirmed
Workshop validated
STAGE 2 – PRODUCT CREATION (AI–ASSISTED)
Product Created
Product name
Linked to verified artisan
Category assignment
Images Uploaded
Primary image of gallery
Multi-image gallery
STAGE 3 – PURCHASE & CERTIFICATEGENERATION
Order Placed
Customer opts for authenticity
Visual verification
Certificate Created
Unique certificate number
Product serial number
Buyer and artisan details
STAGE 4 – PURCHASE & CERTIFICATE
CERTIFICATE ANATOMY
Artisania Verified ✓
Handwoven Pashmina Shawl
Crafted by Ada Fatima
Material: 100% Cashmere
Category: Textiles
Bought by: Emma Harper
Certificate No: ART202406381
Product Serial No: 263NINA03421
Issued Date: April 27, 2022
TRUST LAYER 3
Cryptographic security
Decentralized storage
Permanent and verifiable
VERIFICATION TECHNICAL FLOW
User
Frontend
Backend
IPFS
Database
Database
QR ecan initiates verification request
Retairen verite
Unbnety confimed
Workshop validated
API call to certificate
Database
IPFS exsance check
hurnert protect rotev
Every product on Artisania mainscants a verified chain of trust from artisan to customet, secured by cryptography, enhanced bu AI, and preserved permanently through decentralized storage.

# Feasibility & Viability

## Why this can work

- Growing ethical consumer market
- Digital platforms scale cheaply
- Modular architecture
- Incremental rollout possible

Supported by market studies & platform theory

# Limitations

What Artisania does NOT solve alone

Operational verification cost

Dependence on initial data accuracy

External infrastructure constraints

# Future Vision

- User studies & real deployment
- Partnerships with cultural institutions
- Advanced discovery & analytics
- Expansion beyond Pakistan

# Final Message

**Artisania is not just an e-commerce platform.**

It is:

- A **managed digital marketplace**, not an open bazaar
- A **trust-by-design platform**, not rating-based commerce
- A **digital transformation of handicrafts**, not simple export
- A **knowledge management system**, capturing and preserving artisan know-how
- A **social-impact marketplace**, empowering women and artisan communities

# Thank you!

Artisania

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